PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Toyota 4Runner 6th Gen

2025–present · N500 · i-FORCE · i-FORCE MAX

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Hybrid or not?**
  The hybrid is mandatory on TRD Pro, Trailhunter and Platinum and a $2,800 option elsewhere (C/D). It brings torque and 23 mpg combined but also weight, a higher cargo floor and no third row. C/D's first drive would skip it; its Tacoma tests found the non-hybrid quicker.
- [ ] **Know which trims have what**
  Only the TRD Off-Road, TRD Pro and Trailhunter have the electronic rear locker; the front anti-roll-bar disconnect is standard on Pro and Trailhunter and optional on the TRD Off-Road. Check the window sticker rather than the badge.
- [ ] **Transmission temperatures**
  Car and Driver saw transmission temps near the red zone during repeated acceleration runs, and forum owners report warnings on long off-road climbs. On a test drive with grades, watch the transmission temperature display; owners suggest 4Lo or holding lower gears in S mode.
- [ ] **Brake squeal TSB**
  Front brakes that squeal in reverse are covered by Toyota TSB T-SB-0046-25, since superseded by T-SB-0006-26, which replaces pads, shims and fitting kit under the 36-month/36,000-mile warranty. Ask whether it has been done.
- [ ] **Steering clunk**
  Some early owners on 4Runner6G.com report a clunk felt through the wheel and brake pedal that Toyota fixed under warranty with a new steering shaft assembly. Drive over broken pavement and feel for it.
- [ ] **Water where it shouldn't be**
  Owners have found water collecting inside the liftgate, cured by removing plugs from its weep holes, and threads report water dripping from the rear doors and mildew in window mouldings. Open the liftgate after rain or a wash.
- [ ] **Recalls and campaigns**
  Run the VIN at NHTSA: 2025 trucks are in an instrument-panel software recall (25V-595), several 2026 trucks in load-capacity label recalls (26V-571, 26V-282), and owners have received a front air-dam hardware campaign letter.
- [ ] **Range**
  Forum owners complain of roughly 280 miles between fill-ups in mixed use. If you tow or roam far from fuel, plan for a jerry can — an aftermarket long-range tank wasn't confirmed for the 4Runner in that thread.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Instrument panel software**
  2025 · NHTSA 25V-595

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- [ ] **Load-capacity modification label (Gulf States Toyota)**
  2026 · NHTSA 26V-282
- [ ] **Load-capacity modification label**
  2026 (incl. i-Force Max) · NHTSA 26V-571
- [ ] **Model codes**
  TZNA50/55 for the gas 2.4 turbo i-Force; TZNH55 for the i-Force Max hybrid (4WD only).
- [ ] **Hybrid or not**
  i-Force Max is standard on Platinum, TRD Pro and Trailhunter, and optional on TRD Off-Road, TRD Off-Road Premium and Limited. The hybrid battery sits under the load floor, so hybrids have no third-row option (Car and Driver).
- [ ] **Trailhunter**
  Old Man Emu 2.5 in forged shocks with rear remote reservoirs, ARB-designed roof rack, high-mounted intake, steel skids, about 2 in more front and 1.5 in more rear clearance, heritage grille with bronze TOYOTA letters, and a 20 in LED light bar.
- [ ] **4WD system**
  Part-time 4WD with low range on most trims; full-time 4WD with a locking centre diff on Platinum and some Limiteds.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/4runner/6th-gen/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks